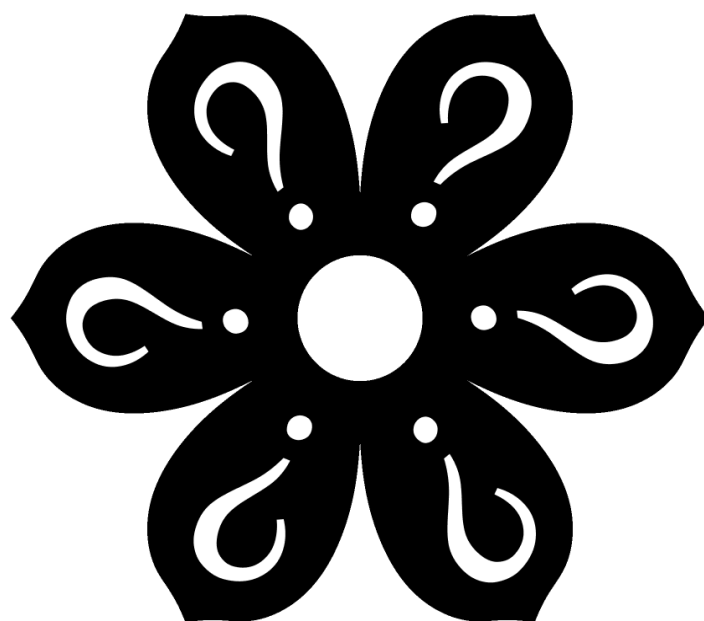




GRADWRITE

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PACK 4

6-Part Blitz

1. What streamer's attempts not to laugh at a young fan complaining that his mom is "kinda homeless" became a viral reaction GIF?
A: **IShowSpeed** (prompt: Speed)
2. What type of blood vessel names a process by which liquids can flow through narrow spaces, even against gravity?
A: **capillary** (accept: capillaries)
3. The epithet "trivia" was given to what ancient Greek god, acknowledging her role as the god of crossroads and magic?
A: **Hecate**
4. What two-word name is given to the seventh degree of the major scale?
A: **leading tone** (accept: leading note)
5. What derogatory nickname is given to the player chosen last in the NFL draft?
A: "Mr. **Irrelevant**"
6. What is the occupational name for someone who makes arrows?
A: **fletcher**

Set of 4: Prophecies

7. What phrase, literally translating to "voice from the outer world," refers to the messiah prophesized to come to the Fremmen ["FREM-en"] in *Dune*?
A: **Lisan al-Gaib**
8. Catherine de' Medici was a prominent believer in what 16th century astrologer, whose book *Les Prophéties* is said to have predicted the Great Fire of London?
A: **Nostradamus**
9. What religious leader and prophet founded "Prophetstown" in Indiana alongside his brother and leader of the Shawnee Tribe, Tecumseh?
A: **Tenskwatawa**
10. In what year did New Age believers predict an apocalypse, corresponding to the end-date of a b'ak'tun in the Mesoamerican Long Count calendar?
A: **2012**

Jackpot

11.
Part 1: What adjective describes "combinations" of vectors which together comprise the span of the set of vectors?
Part 2: This adjective describes "transformations" between vector spaces that preserve addition and scalar multiplication.
Part 3: Systems of equations can be solved using matrices in a branch of mathematics whose name applies this adjective to the word "algebra".
Part 4: A constant slope characterizes a type of function described by this adjective which can be written in Cartesian form as $y = mx + b$.

A: linear

Set of 3: French Desserts

14. What French dessert with a "catalana" variant consists of a bowl of custard covered with a hard layer of caramelized sugar?

A: crème brûlée

15. The narrator is flooded with memories after biting into a tea-soaked madeleine in the first of seven volumes of what novel by Marcel Proust?

A: À la recherche du temps perdu (accept: In Search of Lost Time, Remembrance of Things Past)

16. The water already present makes the dough rise when baked in the process for making what type of pastry used in profiteroles and éclairs?

A: choux pastry (accept: pâte à choux)

Double Jump

17. What Indo-Aryan language, used to write most Mahayana Buddhist sutras, is the sacred language of Hinduism?

A: Sanskrit

18. What other Indo-Aryan language, in which the Theravada *Tipiṭaka* was written, is considered the sacred language of Theravada Buddhism?

A: Pāli

Double Jump

19. Reflections of clicks in the thousands of kilohertz are used by bats as part of what method of navigation?

A: echolocation

20. What family of mainly fruit-eating bats is the only one unable to echolocate using its larynx, and contains the largest species of bat?

A: Megabat (accept: flying foxes, Pteropodidae, Old World fruit bats)

5-Part Mystery Link

21. What Christian, non-violent preacher was written to humanize the suffering of slavery in a namesake Harriet Beecher Stowe novel?

A: Uncle Tom

22. *Brokeback Mountain* lost the Academy Award for Best Picture to what Sandra Bullock-led movie depicting race relations in Los Angeles?

A: Crash

23. What NASA astronaut was the only person on the investigative boards for both the *Challenger* and *Columbia* disasters, and was the first American woman in space?

A: Sally Ride

24. What word beginning with S can refer to a wire noose set up to trap animals?

A: **snare**

25. The common names of the fish *Micropterus dolomieu* and *Dicentrarchus labrax* both include what word?

A: **bass**

All answers are parts of a drum set.

END OF FIRST QUARTER

SECOND QUARTER

Splits: Mountainous Borders in Europe & Thermodynamics

Mountainous Borders in Europe

26. Mount Narodnaya is the highest point in what mountain range, which marks the separation between European Russia and Siberia?

A: **Ural** Mountains

27. What mountain located on the France–Italy border is the highest mountain in the Alps?

A: **Mont Blanc**

28. The daughter of Bebryx names what mountain range which straddles the border of France and Spain?

A: **Pyrenees**

29. The border between what two countries includes Vrashka Chuka, the northwesternmost peak of the Balkan mountains?

A: **Bulgaria** AND **Serbia**

Thermodynamics

30. The change in what quantity is the difference between heat added to and work done by a system, by the first law of thermodynamics?

A: total internal **energy**

31. The boiling point of water is at 373 on what temperature scale, which begins at absolute zero?

A: **Kelvin** scale

32. What thermodynamic quantity, proportional to the logarithm of the number of possible microstates for a given amount of energy, is a rough measure of the amount of "chaos" present in a system?

A: **entropy**

33. What alloy of nickel and iron is named for its remarkably low coefficient of thermal expansion?

A: Invar

Set of 3: Towns Encased By Domes

34. Seahaven Island is revealed to be fully surrounded by a dome-shaped sound stage at the end of what 1998 film?

A: *The Truman Show*

35. On what city does the EPA drop an enormous glass dome in *The Simpsons Movie*?

A: Springfield

36. What author's fictional town of Chester's Mill is abruptly separated from the rest of the world by a transparent dome in *Under the Dome*?

A: Stephen King

Set of 4: Who's Afraid Of...

37. What full name replaces "The Big Bad Wolf" in a parody that George and Martha repeatedly sing throughout an Edward Albee play of the same name?

A: Virginia Woolf

38. What broad 20th-century art movement includes Barnett Newman's *Who's Afraid of Red, Yellow and Blue* series and colour field paintings by Mark Rothko?

A: abstract expressionism

39. In what 2024 book are global, right-wing populist movements against transgender rights activists investigated by Judith Butler?

A: *Who's Afraid of Gender?*

40. What musician included "Who's Afraid of Little Old Me?" on her 2024 album *The Tortured Poets Department*?

A: Taylor Swift

Double Jump

41. What author included a plotline about the skater Levin's courtship of Kitty in his sprawling novel *Anna Karenina*?

A: Leo Tolstoy

42. The title magistrate begins suffering increasingly debilitating pain after falling down while trying to hang curtains in what other Tolstoy novel?

A: *The Death of Ivan Ilyich* ["ILL-itch"]

Double Jump

43. What is the singular form of the word "data"?

A: **datum**

44. What is the singular form of the word "opera"?

A: **opus**

6-Part Chain

45. What Biblical figure was depicted by Alexandre Cabanel in *The Fallen Angel*?

A: **Lucifer** (accept: the **Devil**, accept: **Satan**, but reveal: **Lucifer**)

46. In both *Hazbin Hotel* and a namesake Netflix TV show, what is the surname of Lucifer?

A: **Morningstar**

47. The brightest natural point-like object in the night sky is what planet known as the "morning star"?

A: **Venus**

48. What body parts are missing from a famous two-metre-tall sculpture in the Louvre called the Venus de Milo?

A: **arms**

49. What U.S. Constitutional amendment protects the right for individuals to keep and bear arms?

A: **Second** Amendment (prompt: **Bill of Rights**)

50. In 1967, what element's hyperfine transition was used to define the SI base unit of a second?

A: **cesium** (accept: **Cs**)

END OF FIRST HALF

THIRD QUARTER

Splits: Ancient Mesopotamia & SOS in Music

Ancient Mesopotamia

51. Scenes of war are contrasted with a banquet scene on what artifact, which was recovered from the "Royal Cemetery" of its namesake ancient Mesopotamian city?

A: the Royal **Standard of Ur**

52. What city's king Nebuchadnezzar II likely constructed its legendary "hanging gardens"?

A: **Babylon**

53. What empire was home to the oldest known library in the world, the Library of Ashurbanipal, in its capital Nineveh?

A: Neo-**Assyrian** Empire

54. A relief in the U.S. Capitol building incorrectly depicts the god Shamash in place of what Babylonian king, who is depicted on a stele receiving his namesake "code" of laws from Shamash?

A: **Hammurabi**

SOS in Music

55. Approximately a quarter of the lyrics of what song by The Police consist of the repeated line "sendin' out an SOS"?

A: **"Message in a Bottle"**

56. What singer sampled Soft Cell's "Tainted Love" in her 2006 single "SOS," in which she asks, "this time please, someone come and rescue me"?

A: Robyn **Rihanna Fenty** (accept either underlined part)

57. What singer's album *SOS* contained her first song to hit the *Billboard* top 100, "Kill Bill"?

A: **SZA** (accept: Solána Imani **Rowe**)

58. What band cites "the love you gave me" as the only thing which can save them in their song "SOS"?

A: **ABBA**

Set of 4: Tests

59. Often labelled one of the hardest tests ever, what annual, nationally coordinated undergraduate entrance exam is taken by mainland Chinese students?

A: **Gaokao** (accept: **N**ational **C**ollege **E**ntrance **E**xamination)

60. What word describes both a "test" consisting of a deciding question asked to a candidate for a high political office and a type of paper which, in an acidic medium, turns from blue to red?

A: **litmus**

61. Debates rage over whether the bottom right quadrant should be yellow or purple in what online test that places its participants on left-right and authoritarian-libertarian axes?

A: The **Political Compass**

62. A curve that passes the vertical line test is the graph of an example of what type of mathematical object?

A: **function**

Jailbreak

63. At 50 points, a roll after which all five dice show the same number is the most valuable result in and the namesake of what dice game?

A: **Yahtzee!**

64. The most-streamed song by Deep Blue Something and a 1961 film starring Audrey Hepburn as Holly Golightly both share what three-word title?

A: **"Breakfast at Tiffany's"**

65. Teams from what city received the first pick in both the 2025 WNBA and NBA drafts, which they used to select Paige Bueckers ["BECK-ers"] and Cooper Flagg respectively?

A: **Dallas**

66. A "bulls-eye" rash is symptomatic of what tick-borne disease?

A: **Lyme** disease (accept: **Lyme borreliosis**)

67. Enemies like Serpentine are defeated through the elemental power of Spinjitzu in what Lego series?

A: Lego **Ninjago: Masters Of Spinjitzu**

68. Yemen, Sudan, and Saudi Arabia all border what inlet sea?

A: **Red** Sea

69. What author wrote about the Trask family's life in the Salinas Valley in his novel *East of Eden*?

A: John **Steinbeck**

70. Jayavarman II was the founder of what empire which built the Bayon temple and Angkor Wat?

A: **Khmer** ["kuh-MAI"] Empire (accept: **Kambuja**)

71. What architect, the creator of the geodesic dome, is the namesake of a 60-carbon molecule nicknamed a "buckyball"?

A: Buckminster **Fuller**

72. What artist included "Cats" and "That White Cat" on a 2026 album whose physical cover depicts a tiger pouncing on a cat, *Nothing's About to Happen to Me*?

A: **Mitski** (accept: Mitsuki **Laycock**, Mitski **Miyawaki**)

73. What musical term comes from the Italian for "detached"?

A: **staccato**

74. The abbreviation "EVOO" ["E-V-O-O"] typically stands for the name of what liquid substance in cooking?

A: **extra virgin olive oil**

75. What language commonly spoken in Kolkata, India, is also the sole official language of a neighbouring country?

A: **Bengali**

END OF THIRD QUARTER

FOURTH QUARTER

Jackpot

76.

Part 1: What American state is the source of the Maumee river, which previously drained the Great Black Swamp?

Part 2: The Wabash is this state's longest river, and forms part of its western border.

Part 3: This state is home to a namesake Dunes National Park, located between Michigan City to the east and Gary to the west.

Part 4: This state, which is bordered by Michigan to the north, Ohio to the east, Kentucky to the south, and Illinois to the west, is known as "the Hoosier ["HOO-zhur"] State".

A: **Indiana**

Set of 3: The Letter "Y" in Pop Culture

All answers will begin with the letter Y.

79. Described as the "Destruction Pokémon", what legendary Pokémon is the mascot for *Pokémon Y*?

A: **Yveltal** ["ee-VELL-tall"]

80. A group of high schoolers fight against newly sentient technology at a New Year's party in what 2024 horror comedy, named after a turn-of-the-millennium tech issue?

A: **Y2K**

81. TREASURE, BABYMONSTER, and BLACKPINK are all groups under what South Korean record label?

A: **YG** Entertainment

Set of 4: Neoclassical Painting

82. Neoclassicism is often considered a response to what earlier artistic movement exemplified by Jean-Honoré Fragonard's *The Swing*?

A: **Rococo** (accept: **Late Baroque**)

83. Neoclassical portraitist Élisabeth Vigée Le Brun was the court painter of what French noblewoman, the wife of Louis XVI ["the sixteenth"]?

A: **Marie Antoinette**

84. What Neoclassical Swiss artist and founding member of the Royal Academy painted *Cornelia Presenting Her Children as Her Treasures*?

A: Angelica **Kauffman**

85. The cover of Have a Nice Life's album *Deathconsciousness* features what Jacques-Louis David painting, which depicts Charlotte Corday's assassination of the title French revolutionary?

A: The **Death of Marat** (accept: *La Mort de Marat, Marat Assassiné*)

15-Part Blitz

86. What type of monster were Stheno, Euryale, and their sister, whose face is depicted on Athena's shield?

A: **gorgons**

87. Who became the first African American author to win a Pulitzer Prize for *Annie Allen*, but is better known for penning "The Bean Eaters" and "We Real Cool"?

A: Gwendolyn **Brooks**

88. Situated at the Schwarzschild radius, what astrophysical boundary marks the point at which light cannot escape from a black hole?

A: **event horizon**

89. Brother Walfrid founded what Scottish football club as a charity to raise money for hungry children in the East End of Glasgow?

A: **Celtic** FC (accept: **Celtic** Football Club)

90. Sundiata Keita founded what West African empire which peaked under the reign of Mansa Musa?

A: **Mali** Empire

91. Inspired by seeing a flock of swans take flight, the "swan hymn" appears in what Finnish composer's fifth symphony?

A: Jean **Sibelius**

92. What Latin term, contrasted with "mens rea", denotes someone who committed a "guilty act"?

A: **actus reus**

93. Anzac Day commemorates the sacrifices by the armies of what two countries, whose names are the "ANZ" in the acronym ANZAC?

A: **Australia** AND **New Zealand**

94. Brie Larson voices Princess Rosalina, who is rescued by Princess Peach in what animated movie sequel?

A: The **Super Mario Galaxy Movie** (prompt: *Super Mario Galaxy*)

95. What revolutionary served as the first president of the Philippines shortly before its conquest by the United States?

A: Emilio **Aguinaldo**

96. The "One-Winged Angel" is a nickname for what fictional character, the main antagonist of Final Fantasy VII ["seven"]?

A: **Sephiroth**

97. What body of water between the South Shetland Islands and Cape Horn connects the Atlantic and Pacific Oceans?

A: **Drake Passage**

98. In hobby keyboard-building, what 5-letter word describes a deeper sound profile than "clack"?

A: **thock**

99. What language is the source of the English words "nosh", "glitch", and "klutz"?

A: **Yiddish**

100. Used by Gordie Howe to describe his distinct defensive playing style, what two-word phrase has been adopted by Canadians as a response to threats of tariffs and annexation from Donald Trump?

A: **elbows up**

END OF GAME